# James Chang

Senior Product Manager

Founder,

Aleph Co.

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A career of product instinct. Shipping now at AI speed.

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## Summary

Fifteen years sourcing products across Asia and the US — at YETI, at Cheng Loong in Shanghai, at AT&T Wireless — taught me what real importers need. Then Senior PM at Gannett/LocaliQ, where I took Scheduling from concept to shipped product inside a media company and picked up SEO and GenAI ownership along the way.

I started using AI for product work early — first for research and competitive analysis, then prototyping, then building entire products. Today I design, prototype, and ship full-stack applications using Claude Code, Cursor, and Gemini. Not prompting for code snippets — architecting systems, writing tests, deploying to production. AI didn't replace the PM skillset; it gave me a way to go from insight to working software without waiting for a sprint.

Now I combine both backgrounds — founding Aleph Co. to build compliance tooling for the sourcers I used to be, while shipping seven other products in parallel because the operator problems I know best aren't confined to one market.

MBA from USC Marshall (2012), CSPO, and a lifetime food blog at The Thirsty Pig. Based in Los Angeles.

## Experience

### Aleph Co. (Pasadena Works LLC) — Founder & Operator

Sept 2025 – Present · Los Angeles, CA

- Founded and operate Aleph, a B2B SaaS compliance platform for US importers covering FDA FSVP, CPSIA/CPC, California Prop 65, and multi-state PFAS regulations.
- Ship six additional products in parallel under Aleph Co. — see Projects for the portfolio and deep-dives.

### LocaliQ / USA Today Network — Senior Product Manager

Mar 2022 – Oct 2024 · Woodland Hills, CA

- Owned Scheduling end-to-end as Senior PM — product strategy, roadmap, discovery, and launch — leading a cross-functional pod of engineering, design, QA, and Customer Success partners.
- Reached **4,900 free + 400 paid accounts in year one** against an internal plan projecting meaningfully smaller numbers. Shipped **8,000+ booked appointments in the first six months** via Google Calendar, Outlook, and SMS integrations — the things competitors paywalled, which I argued for over AI-rule features that later got added in v2.
- Expanded scope to include LocaliQ's SEO offering and its GenAI/Jasper tooling; defined the KPI and instrumentation layer that fed Sales and CS dashboards across the revenue org.
- **Press & bylines:** Gannett/USA Today press release (Dec 2022) · Appointment Scheduling Simplified, LocaliQ Blog (Feb 2023).

### Sunrise Integration — Product / Project Manager

Dec 2019 – Jun 2020 · Los Angeles, CA

- Owned WarehouseConnector.com product and integration delivery for OMS/ERP/CRM/WMS workflows used by logistics operators.
- Led platform migrations (**Magento → Shopify**) and ERP modernization initiatives (**NetSuite**); coordinated requirements, dependencies, and UAT.
- Led stakeholder demos and acceptance testing to drive adoption and minimize regression risk.

### Movley — Product / Operations Manager (now Ops Ninja)

Jun 2019 – Nov 2019 · Los Angeles, CA (Remote)

- Delivered operational dashboards for manufacturing inspections and overseas fulfillment workflows.
- Built and managed distributed operations teams (China, Philippines) supporting U.S. manufacturing customers.

### MEDL Mobile — Product / Project Manager

Apr 2018 – Dec 2018 · Irvine, CA

- Led requirements, QA, and App Store submissions for mobile apps across consumer and emerging-tech engagements.
- Coordinated cross-functional delivery for multiple shipped applications under tight timelines and external stakeholder expectations.

## Education

### USC Marshall School of Business

Master of Business Administration (MBA), 2012. Class President.

### Certifications

Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO), Scrum Alliance · 2019

Product Management Certificate, Product School · 2018

## Skills

**Product:** 0→1 development, roadmapping, discovery & user research, A/B testing, GenAI integration, native-mobile PM

**Tools:** Jira, Linear, Productboard, Figma, Notion, Confluence, Slack, Mixpanel, PostHog, Sentry, Google Analytics 4, Appcues, Stripe, Shopify, GitHub, Postman

**AI-assisted engineering:** Claude Code, Cursor, Gemini, ChatGPT Codex, VS Code, Xcode, Replit, MCP · TypeScript, Python, Next.js, React Native/Expo, Astro, Tailwind, FastAPI, Express, Prisma, Drizzle, Socket.IO

**Infrastructure:** Vercel, Railway, Render, Supabase, Neon, TinaCMS, BullMQ/Redis, Playwright, Tesseract.js OCR

**Domains:** B2B SaaS, regulatory compliance, fantasy sports, food & dining, global supply chain & sourcing

**Languages:** English (native), Mandarin (verbal fluency), Taiwanese (verbal fluency)

## Projects

A mix of real businesses, side projects, and experiments — compliance SaaS, fantasy sports, karaoke, BBQ judging, food blogging, and more. All AI-assisted, all shipped by one person.

**Aleph Co.**
Product compliance for US importers. FDA FSVP, CPSIA/CPC, California Prop 65, multi-state PFAS — one platform.

**Bahtzang Trader**
AI trading-decision experiment using Claude Sonnet. Paper-trading sandbox — not a live trading service.

**TableDrop**
Restaurant reservation marketplace. Sellers list hard-to-get tables, buyers purchase them. Next.js + Stripe + Playwright.

**The Fantastic Leagues**
Fantasy baseball with league-context AI. 26 feature modules, 730 tests, 8 AI features (Gemini + Claude), live auction WebSockets.

**The Judge Tool**
Digital KCBS BBQ competition judging. Real-time tabulation, audit trails, 16,424 LOC + 113 tests shipped in 20 days.

**KTV Singer**
YouTube-powered karaoke system. Phone & Apple TV pairing, synced lyrics, shared queue. Expo + SwiftUI + Express + Socket.IO + Supabase. Seven-repo monorepo.

**Tastemakers**
iOS restaurant-review app. 1,000+ downloads in 3 months with no paid acquisition. Laravel 8 + PostgreSQL + Redis + Firebase push; Google Places + Foursquare APIs. Currently paused.

**The Thirsty Pig**
Food and travel blog since 2007. 2026 rebuild: 923 posts recovered from the Wayback Machine, 1,649 Instagram posts archived, 2,900+ pages.

## Volunteer Experience

### Chinese American Museum  Board Member

Feb 2026 – Present · Los Angeles, CA

Serving on the board of the Chinese American Museum in downtown Los Angeles, the first museum in the United States dedicated to the history and ongoing story of Chinese Americans.

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### Kansas City Barbeque Society  Certified Barbeque Judge (CBJ) · Lifetime Member

2022 – Present

KCBS-certified Barbeque Judge since 2022. Lifetime member; judged 12+ sanctioned competitions. The domain knowledge behind building The Judge Tool.

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